

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 11 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 4 Curriculum Architecture & Edexcel GCSE Specification

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1) History Specification (1H10)

Meoncross School delivers a balanced 4-unit curriculum covering thematic development, British depth, period conflict, and modern world history:

Exam Paper & Topic	Assessment Focus	Weighting	Format & Marks	Taught Cohort
Paper 1 (1H10/11): Medicine in Britain (c.1250–present) & Western Front (1914–18)	Thematic Study & Historic Environment	30% of GCSE	1 hr 15 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 11
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)	Period Study	20% of GCSE	50 mins 32 marks	Year 10
Paper 2 (1H10/26): Early Elizabethan England (1558–1588)	British Depth Study	20% of GCSE	55 mins 32 marks	Year 11
Paper 3 (1H10/31): Weimar and Nazi Germany (1918–1939)	Modern Depth Study	30% of GCSE	1 hr 20 mins 52 marks (incl. 4 SPaG)	Year 10

Assessment Objectives (AOs)

- AO1 (35%):** Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of key features.
- AO2 (35%):** Explain and analyse events, causes, consequences, and change.
- AO3 (15%):** Analyse, evaluate, and use contemporary sources.
- AO4 (15%):** Analyse and evaluate historical interpretations in context.

Standardized Question Frameworks

- 4-mark Consequence:** PEE structure (immediate & long-term).
- 8-mark Narrative:** 3-phase chronological causal flowchart.
- 8-mark Importance:** Analytical criteria for historical impact.
- 2+2 Features:** Concisely identifying and developing features.
- 8-mark Utility:** Evaluating content and provenance (Author/Audience/Motive).
- 16+4 Judgement Essays:** Evaluative criteria with sustained balance.

Mastery Methodology: GCSE pupils utilize printed Edexcel Mastery Booklets featuring 3-tier models, formula stamps, and walking-talking mock rehearsals, ensuring complete familiarity with mark schemes and timing constraints prior to the final examinations.

Paper 1: Medicine Through Time with the Western Front

Year 11 | How has medicine changed from c1250 to the modern day?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 KT1.1: What did Medieval people believe caused illness?	- Explain how supernatural and religious factors influenced beliefs about the cause of illness. - Analyse the rational, natural theories of disease used in medieval England.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Four Humours  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Medieval Church's Impact on Medicine: For decades, traditional historians portrayed the medieval Catholic Church as a dogmatic ins  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe two features of Galen's Theory of Opposites. (4 marks)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 KT1.2: How did Medieval people try to prevent and treat disease?	- Explain the connection between medieval beliefs about disease and their approaches to treatment and prevention. - Evaluate the roles, training, and accessibility of different medical healers in medieval society.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Medieval Bloodletting  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Effectiveness of Medieval Hospitals: Traditional historical accounts often dismissed medieval hospitals as dirty, unhygienic place  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe two features of the role of the medieval apothecary. (4 marks)
Lesson 3 KT1.3: How did people respond to the Black Death?	- Explain the religious and supernatural responses to the Black Death. - Analyse the rational and governmental methods used to prevent and treat the plague.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Black Death  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Socio-Economic Impact of the Black Death: Historians are deeply divided over the long-term impact of the Black Death on medieval E  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe two features of how medieval people tried to prevent the spread of the Black Death. (4 marks)
Lesson 4 KT2.1: Did the Renaissance change beliefs about the causes of illness?	- Explain how Thomas Sydenham's scientific approach to observation changed the diagnosis of disease. - Assess the role of the printing press and the Royal Society in communicating and spreading scientific ideas.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Printing Press  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Pace of Change in Renaissance Medicine: Historians often debate the extent to which the Renaissance c1500-c1700 represented a genu  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [12 Marks] Explain why there were changes in the way ideas about the causes of disease and illness were communicated in the period c1500-c1700. (12 marks)
Lesson 5 KT2.2: Did treatments improve during the Renaissance?	- Analyze the continuities and changes in Renaissance treatments and preventions, including the impact of exploration and alchemy. - Explain how institutional changes, specifically the Dissolution of the Monasteries, altered hospital care in England.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Pare and Paracelsus  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over Renaissance Progress: Breakthrough or Backstep?: Historians actively debate whether the Renaissance represented genuine progress in pa  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [12 Marks] Explain why there was rapid progress in anatomical knowledge in the Renaissance period (c1500-c1700). (12 marks)
Lesson 6 KT2.3: How significant were William Harvey and the Great Plague?	- Explain the significance of William Harvey's discovery and the reasons for its limited short-term impact. - Compare the government and public responses to the 1665 Great Plague with the 1348 Black Death.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Harvey on the Heart  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Significance of William Harvey: Historians often debate whether William Harvey represents a sudden turning point or a very gradual  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [16 Marks] 'The most effective method of preventing the spread of the Great Plague (1665) was the use of quarantine.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?	- Explain the difference between Spontaneous Generation and Germ Theory. - Analyze the significance of Robert Koch's scientific methodology in microbiology.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Pasteur in the Lab  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Pace of the Germ Theory Revolution: Historians actively debate how quickly Germ Theory transformed medical beliefs in Britain. Whi  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe two features of Robert Koch's scientific methods for identifying bacteria. (4 marks)
Lesson 8 KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?	- Explain how hospital care and nursing standards were transformed c1700–c1900 under the influence of Florence Nightingale. - Analyse how the breakthroughs of anaesthetics and antiseptics solved the critical surgical problems of pain and infection. - Evaluate the role of government intervention in disease prevention through the 1875 Public Health Act.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Florence Nightingale  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the 'Black Period' of Surgery: Historians frequently debate the immediate consequences of James Simpson's 1847 discovery of chloroform  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [16 Marks] 'The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700–c1900.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for ...
Lesson 9 KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?	- Explain the significance and limitations of Edward Jenner's development of the smallpox vaccine. - Analyze how John Snow investigated the 1854 cholera epidemic and assess the significance of his findings.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Broad Street Pump  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Catalysts for Victorian Public Health Reform: Historians debate the extent to which John Snow's 1854 Broad Street investigation wa  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [12 Marks] Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850–c1900). (12 marks)
Lesson 10 KT4.1: How have modern discoveries changed our understanding of illness?	- Explain how the discovery of DNA and the Human Genome Project transformed the understanding of genetic and hereditary illnesses. - Analyze the influence of lifestyle choices on modern health and the impact of technology on medical diagnosis.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: DNA Structure  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Significance of DNA vs. Germ Theory: GCSE historians frequently debate whether the 1953 discovery of the structure of DNA represen  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 'The discovery of DNA was the most significant breakthrough in understanding the causes of illness in the period c1900–present.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks) You ...
Lesson 11 KT4.2: How have prevention and treatment advanced in the modern era?	- Explain how scientific and technological developments led to the creation of magic bullets and antibiotics. - Analyze the impact of the National Health Service (NHS) on the provision of and access to medical care.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The NHS Established  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Significance of the Beveridge Report in the Foundation of the NHS: Historians debate the extent to which the 1942 Beveridge Report  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [12 Marks] Explain why there was rapid progress in disease prevention in the period c1900–present. (12 marks)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 12 KT4.3: How was Penicillin discovered and mass-produced?	- Contrast the roles of Alexander Fleming with those of Howard Florey and Ernst Chain in the penicillin breakthrough. - Analyze how the factors of government intervention, science and technology, and war collaborated to enable the mass production of penicillin.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Fleming and Penicillin  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the 'Myth' of Fleming and the Penicillin Breakthrough: For decades, popular historical accounts portrayed Alexander Fleming as the sol  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [16 Marks] 'Alexander Fleming was the most important individual in the development of penicillin.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)
Lesson 13 KT4.4: How has the government tackled the modern epidemic of Lung Cancer?	- Explain how modern science and technology have transformed the diagnosis and treatment of lung cancer since c1900. - Analyze the effectiveness and changing focus of government legislation to prevent smoking-related lung cancer.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Anti-Smoking Campaign  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Motives for Modern Public Health Interventions: Historians of modern medicine actively debate what primarily drove the British gov  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [12 Marks] Explain why the government took action to improve public health in the period c1900-present. (12 marks)
Lesson 14 KT5.1: What was the historical and medical context of the Western Front?	Explain the state of surgical asepsis, radiology, and transfusion science on the eve of World War I.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Western Front  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Source of Medical Innovation in World War I: Historians of military medicine debate whether the rapid medical advances of the Firs  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 1 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the problem of storing blood for transfusions before the First World War? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your kno...
Lesson 15 KT5.2: How did the trench environment create new medical challenges?	- Explain the causes, symptoms, and preventive strategies developed to combat trench foot and trench fever. - Analyze the impact of weaponry on injuries, specifically focusing on shrapnel, head injuries, and gas gangrene from soil.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Map of the Somme Offensive  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Treatment and Diagnosis of Shell Shock (NYD.N): Historians of military medicine actively debate the British Army's evolving respon  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 2 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the impact of the terrain on the transport of the wounded on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and yo...
Lesson 16 KT5.3: What new illnesses and wounds did soldiers face?	- Explain the connection between artillery weaponry, shrapnel, and the introduction of the steel Brodie helmet in 1915. - Analyse how the muddy, manured environment of Flanders led to severe wound infections like gas gangrene and tetanus.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The devastated, muddy terrain of Passchendaele  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Diagnosis and Treatment of Shell Shock (NYD.N): Historians of military medicine are deeply divided over the British Army's respons  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 2 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the effects of poison gas attacks on soldiers on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 17 KT5.4: How did the RAMC and FANY operate the chain of evacuation?	- Explain the four main stages of the Western Front chain of evacuation and the mode of transport between them. - Evaluate the roles, significance, and contributions of the RAMC and FANY on the Western Front.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Primary Role of Casualty Clearing Stations: Historians of military medicine actively debate how the roles of Casualty Clearing Sta  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 2 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the problems of transporting the wounded on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of t...
Lesson 18 KT5.5: What incredible medical advances were forged on the Western Front?	- Explain how the Thomas splint and mobile X-ray units solved critical evacuation and surgical challenges. - Analyze the development of blood transfusion and the significance of the first blood bank at the Battle of Cambrai.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Debate over the Western Front as a Catalyst for Medical Innovation: Military and social historians actively debate the true significance of the Fi  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: 2 (a). How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the effectiveness of new medical developments used to treat wounded soldiers on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sou...

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–88

Year 11 | From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 KT1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Religious Divide  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the interconnected domestic and foreign threats facing England in 1558, specifically severe financial weaknesses, the loss of Calais, and the dangerous 'Auld Alliance' between France and Scotland.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of Elizabethan society in 1558. • Describe one feature of Elizabethan government in 1558. • Describe one feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced upon her ...
Lesson 2 KT1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Act of Supremacy  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the nature and extent of the Puritan and Catholic challenges to the religious settlement, including the role of the nobility, the Papacy, and foreign powers.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559). • Describe one feature of the Act of Uniformity (1559). • Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in society. • Desc...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 KT1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Papal Bull  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Understand the nature and extent of the Puritan challenge, focusing on their theological objections, the Crucifix Controversy, and the Vestment Controversy.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement. • Describe one feature of the Catholic challenge to the Religious Settlement. • Describe one feature of recusanc...
Lesson 4 KT1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Mary Queen of Scots  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne. • Describe one feature of the relations between Elizabeth and Mary, Queen of Scots, in the years 1568–69. • Expl...
Lesson 5 KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home	- Describe what happened during the Revolt of the Northern Earls. - List the main Catholic plots against Elizabeth. - Explain how Walsingham used spies to catch plotters.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Northern Earls  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70. • Describe one feature of the Ridolfi plot. • Describe one feature of the Throckmorton plot. • Describe one feature of t...
Lesson 6 KT2.2: Relations with Spain	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Philip II of Spain  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of English privateering in the New World. • Describe one feature of the religious rivalry between England and Spain. • Describe one feature of Sir Francis Drake's act...
Lesson 7 KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	- List the reasons why England and Spain became enemies. - Describe what Robert Dudley did in the Netherlands. - Explain how Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz helped England.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Francis Drake  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88. • Describe one feature of Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587. • Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's actions in the ...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 8 KT2.4: The Armada	- List the reasons why Philip II launched the Armada. - Describe the Spanish plan and why it went wrong. - Explain how the English defeated the Armada. - Describe what happened after the Armada was defeated.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Spanish Armada  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the English victory, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the Spanish invasion plans for the Armada. • Describe one feature of English tactics used to defeat the Spanish Armada. • Describe one feature of the Battle of Gra...
Lesson 9 KT3.1: Education and leisure	- Describe the different types of schools in Elizabethan England. - List some sports played by the nobility and the lower classes. - Explain why the theatre was popular and why some people hated it.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Elizabethan Theatre  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the reasons for the sudden explosion of the Elizabethan theatre and why it provoked such fierce opposition from Puritans and city authorities.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of education in Elizabethan Grammar Schools. • Describe one feature of Elizabethan Petty Schools. • Describe one feature of the Elizabethan theatre. • Describe one fe...
Lesson 10 KT3.2: The Problem of Poverty	- List the main reasons why poverty increased. - Describe the difference between the 'deserving' and 'undeserving' poor. - Explain why people were so afraid of vagabonds. - Describe the difference between the 1572 and 1576 Poor Laws.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Poor Law  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the significance of Elizabeth's changing policies, specifically the 1572 Vagabonds Act and the 1576 Poor Relief Act.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. • Describe one feature of the 1576 Poor Relief Act. • Describe one feature of the Houses of Correction. • Explain why there was an increase...
Lesson 11 KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery	- List the reasons why Elizabethan sailors started exploring the world. - Describe Francis Drake's circumnavigation and why it angered Spain. - Explain why Walter Raleigh wanted to start a colony in America. - Describe the reasons why the Virginia colony completely failed.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Golden Hind  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the Virginia colonies, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish war.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of Francis Drake's circumnavigation of the globe. • Describe one feature of the impact of new technology on Elizabethan exploration. • Explain why exploration by the ...
Lesson 12 KT3.4: Raleigh and Virginia	- Explain what Walter Raleigh did to organise the Virginia expeditions. - List the reasons why England wanted a colony in America. - Describe the problems faced by the 1585 and 1587 colonies.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Roanoke Colony  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the catastrophic failure of the 1585 and 1587 expeditions, weighing poor planning against Native American resistance and the Spanish Armada.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Describe one feature of the failure of the first Virginia colony. • Describe one feature of Sir Walter Raleigh's role in the attempted colonisation of Virginia. • Explain why the first co...